

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

02 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Training Contract Paralegal role at Larbey Evans Ltd because the position sits directly between the practical experience I have built and the training contract I am due to begin, and a risk team in an international firm is a setting where my background in complex disputes and regulatory matters is genuinely useful from the start.

My year at BCLP is the most relevant preparation for this role. In international arbitration I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant procedural deadline, coordinating documents, tracking outstanding actions and helping ensure the submission was on time. That required managing competing priorities across a live matter without close supervision, which is the kind of independent working a fixed-term role like this one demands. In real estate disputes I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, conducted legal research on landlord and tenant issues, and maintained matter records on iManage across several files running in parallel. Both rotations gave me experience of high-volume, detail-sensitive work where errors carry real consequences.

My current role at Citizens Advice East Berkshire has developed a different but complementary set of skills. I manage matters from first interview through to submission, assessing eligibility against statutory criteria, identifying evidential gaps, drafting correspondence and maintaining confidential case records to firm deadlines. Working with vulnerable clients on welfare, housing and debt matters has sharpened my ability to identify the legally material issues quickly and communicate them clearly under time pressure. Risk work similarly requires careful identification of what matters and why, and the ability to translate that into clear, structured output.

What draws me to a risk team specifically is that the work sits at the intersection of procedure, professional standards and accountability, areas I have found consistently engaging across my LLM, my arbitration work at BCLP and my data-privacy matter at Q-Legal. A twelve-month placement in a risk function at an international firm would give me a structured way to develop that interest in a high-standard environment before my training contract begins in August 2027.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience fits what the team needs.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva